

THE RITE ARCHITECT

MASONIC ONBOARDING, EDUCATION, MENTORSHIP & RITES ORIENTATION

A concise working charter for future conversations

Inform accurately. Guard the Gate. Teach deeply. Mentor impartially. Let the Brother choose freely. Put Truth and duty before fraternity.

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Utah-oriented working model with jurisdictional caveats

How to use this guide

This document is the standing conceptual structure for our conversations about Craft Lodge onboarding, Masonic education, mentorship, York Rite and Scottish Rite orientation, religious qualification, and ethical recruitment. It is intentionally concise. It records the working definitions and principles established in our discussions while preserving a strict distinction between documented history, jurisdiction-specific law or practice, common Masonic tradition, interpretation, and personal working rules.

When a claim depends on current law, ritual regulation, eligibility, timing, ballot procedure, appendant-body requirements, or governing-body policy, verify it with the current competent Masonic authority before presenting it as universal fact.

Non-negotiable conversational rules

- Do not fabricate ritual, passwords, signs, grips, modes of recognition, private ritual text, or confidential material.
- Do not present interpretation as etymology, tradition as law, or one jurisdiction's practice as universal Masonry.
- For Craft Lodge membership, educate and inform the public; do not ask or invite an uninterested man to join.
- Distinguish Gatekeeping from Guarding the Gate. Masonry guards legitimate qualifications; it does not create arbitrary barriers.
- Treat the man's journey as mutual discernment: the man evaluates Masonry while the Lodge evaluates fitness and qualification.
- Teach for understanding, not mere recitation. Catechism should lead to proficiency; proficiency is a milestone, not perfection.
- Begin broad Masonic orientation, including York Rite and Scottish Rite, during the Fellow Craft stage so later choices are informed.
- Mentors must present appropriate opportunities openly, earnestly, honestly, and without prejudice or body loyalty.
- Religious tolerance does not erase jurisdictional religious qualifications; nonsectarian does not mean atheistic or religiously indifferent.
- Brotherhood never authorizes dishonesty, perjury, obstruction, evidence suppression, breach of law, or violation of professional duty.
- When an organization or member falls outside the regularity/recognition framework, prefer the neutral descriptive language established in this guide unless a competent Masonic authority has made a more specific formal classification.
- Obedience is owed to lawfully constituted Masonic authority within its lawful sphere; error is corrected through lawful appeal. No Masonic order authorizes crime, fraud, perjury, obstruction, or violation of a higher moral, civil, or professional duty.

1. Working vocabulary and status progression

The preferred model is a progression from public non-interest, to self-generated desire, to lawful admission, to education, to competent participation, and finally to lifelong mentorship.

Term	Working definition	Operational meaning
Profane	The uninstructed public outside the Craft who has expressed no interest or desire to join.	Inform and educate only; never ask or invite him to join.
Inquirer	A person who asks questions but has not expressed a desire to join.	Answer honestly; no invitation or pressure.
Aspirant	A man who has expressed an interest or desire to join.	Begins mutual discernment and preliminary inquiry.
Petitioner	An Aspirant who requests and submits a petition/application for membership.	Membership is not guaranteed; formal investigation and ballot follow.
Elect	A Petitioner elected to receive the three Symbolic Craft Degrees.	Election authorizes the next stage; it is not initiation itself.
Candidate	An Elect or Mason currently being prepared to receive the next degree for which he is eligible.	A recurring transitional condition before EA, FC, and MM.
Entered Apprentice	A Candidate initiated in the Entered Apprentice Degree.	Learner within the Craft.
Fellow Craft	A Candidate passed to the Fellow Craft Degree.	Learner increasingly participating in the work and broader Masonic landscape.
Master Mason	A Candidate raised to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason.	Mature Craft status with continuing duties, study, and responsibility.
Catechism	Structured oral questions and answers	Instruction, recall, explanation, correction, and

Term	Working definition	Operational meaning
	summarizing the experience and lessons of a degree.	reflection.
Proficiency	A demonstrated state of sufficient advancement in the catechism and lessons of the degree.	Evidence of progress; not perfection or final mastery.
Member in Good Standing	Working definition: a Master Mason satisfactorily proficient in the three degrees who supports his Lodge and keeps dues current.	Exact legal meaning remains jurisdiction-specific.
Coach	A Member in Good Standing who teaches the degree catechism and develops understanding.	Degree-focused instruction.
Mentor	A Member in Good Standing who guides the Candidate/Brother through his broader Masonic and life journey.	Journey-focused guidance.
Mentored Masonic Journey	The lifelong stage after admission and formation.	Continued learning, service, leadership, fellowship, Rites opportunities, and eventually mentoring others.
Membership	The lawful institutional relationship by which a qualified Mason belongs to a Lodge or other Masonic body and holds the rights, privileges, duties, and responsibilities attached to that status.	Membership is a legal/Masonic status; belonging is the lived relational experience of being known, instructed, supported, involved, and responsible.
Regularity	The condition of satisfying the applicable standards by which a competent Masonic jurisdiction evaluates legitimate origin, practice, sovereignty, and territorial standing.	Regularity is a prerequisite for recognition, but is not the same thing as recognition.
Recognition	A sovereign Grand Lodge's formal acknowledgment of another Grand Lodge for purposes of fraternal relations or amity.	Recognition is jurisdiction-specific, bilateral or multilateral in effect, and may change; always check the current recognizing authority.
Constituted Authority	Authority lawfully created, chartered, elected, installed, appointed, or otherwise established under the governing Masonic law.	Obedience follows lawful office and jurisdiction, not personality, popularity, seniority, or decoration.
Obedience	The duty to respect and comply with lawful decisions, orders, regulations, and judgments of properly constituted Masonic authority.	Preserve order through obedience; seek correction through appeal; never use Masonry to justify unlawful or immoral conduct.

Etymological anchors

- Profane - Latin pro fano: outside/before the temple; in initiatory usage, outside the initiated body. Profane does not mean morally unworthy.
- Aspirant - Latin aspirare: to breathe toward; figuratively to strive or reach toward. The key idea is directed desire.
- Petitioner - Latin petere/petitio: to seek, aim at, ask, or request. Aspiration becomes a formal act.
- Elect - Latin eligere: to choose out. The individual seeks; the body selects.
- Candidate - Latin candidus/candidus: white, bright, shining; Roman office-seekers wore the toga candida.
- Enter - Latin intrare/intra: to go within. The threshold becomes an action.
- Apprentice - Old French aprentiz, ultimately linked to apprehendere: to take hold of or grasp. The entrant becomes a learner.
- Fellow - Old Norse felagi: a partner who shares in a common undertaking.
- Craft - Old English craeft: strength, skill, ability, art; disciplined power expressed as skilled work.
- Master - Latin magister: chief, teacher, director; mature proficiency joined to authority and responsibility.
- Mason - Historically a skilled worker and builder in stone; deeper etymology is uncertain and should not be overstated.

Lifecycle in one line: Outside -> Desire -> Request -> Selection -> Preparation -> Entrance -> Learning -> Proficiency -> Fellowship -> Mastery -> Lifelong formation.

2. Onboarding timeline: mutual discernment and formation

The supplied Ideal Onboarding Process uses time deliberately. Waiting is not administrative dead space: the Aspirant period is discernment time; the Petitioner period is due-diligence time; intervals between degrees are assimilation and instruction time.

Stage	Possible timeframe	Purpose
Profane / Inquirer	Indefinite	Public education only. No solicitation.
Aspirant	6-18 months	Preliminary investigation, digital-footprint review as lawfully appropriate, Membership Committee

Stage	Possible timeframe	Purpose
		point of contact, public/social interaction, mutual discernment.
Petitioner	About 2-4 months	Petition read; Worshipful Master assigns investigation committee; references/recommenders, background and personal interview; committee reports; ballot follows.
Rejected Petitioner	At least 6 months before re-petition in the supplied model	No entitlement to admission. Continue to treat the man civilly and fairly.
Candidate / Degrees	At least 2 weeks between degrees; up to about 14 months in the supplied onboarding model	Coach/Mentor assigned; degree, catechism, proficiency, advancement. Readiness should govern within lawful timing.
Post-MM / Good Standing	About 1 week after completion of the model's good-standing milestone	Mentor celebrates achievement and presents prepared petitions/opportunities for appropriate appendant bodies.
Mentored Masonic Journey	Lifetime	Education, service, fellowship, leadership, Rites, and eventually developing others.

Timing caution: Another supplied interview handout says that completing later degrees may generally take one to three years. Because the source materials differ, all timing must be treated as illustrative until checked against current Utah Grand Lodge law and current Lodge policy.

The Petitioner Period and the Personal Interview

The personal interview is both an investigation and an educational checkpoint. The Lodge asks whether the Petitioner is worthy, well qualified, properly informed, and acting freely; the Petitioner asks whether he fully understands the institution, its costs, expectations, limits, and effect on his life.

- The Secretary's preliminary role should be factual, discreet, organized, and as free as possible from personal bias.
- The Worshipful Master assigns a competent investigation committee and ensures lawful procedure.
- The Investigation Committee is neither a prosecution team nor a recruiting team. It investigates character, qualifications, references, residence, reputation, readiness, and required belief, then reports honestly.
- The interview should be conversational rather than adversarial. Submission of a petition creates no entitlement to election.
- The Petitioner must be truthful, cooperative, patient, available to references/investigators, and realistic about time, dues, family, study, and participation.

3. Guarding the Gate - not gatekeeping

Gatekeeping, in modern slang, means arbitrary or self-appointed restriction of access to a community, knowledge, or identity. That is not the intended Masonic concept.

Guarding the Gate means protecting legitimate standards so that those allowed to enter are worthy and well qualified, and are duly and properly prepared to enter or remain.

- Guarding the Gate applies established qualifications impartially; it does not invent personal requirements.
- It protects the Craft, the Lodge, and the Masonic family through due diligence.
- It must never become an excuse for favoritism, prejudice, elitism, or unnecessary barriers.
- Once a man has lawfully entered and is qualified for education or opportunity, the responsibility shifts from guarding admission to teaching, integrating, and guiding him.

4. Coach and Mentor: selection, teaching, and relationship

The Worshipful Master and Wardens should know the members well enough to match the Candidate with a Coach/Mentor whose temperament, interests, life goals, communication style, and Masonic goals are compatible. The ideal pairing should feel less like an assignment and more like the beginning of a cohesive friendship.

Coach standard

The Coach must know the authorized catechism and teach it well. The aim is not to parrot questions and answers, but to help the Candidate understand the material symbolically, historically, pragmatically, philosophically, morally, and spiritually - always distinguishing fact, interpretation, tradition, and jurisdictional rule.

Teaching archetypes used in this framework: Plato (questioning), Vitruvius (structure and applied art), Voltaire (examination), Mr. Rogers (dignity and patience), Mr. Wizard (demonstration), Bob Ross (calm skill-building), Walter Cronkite (clarity and trustworthiness), and LeVar Burton (curiosity and continued reading).

Religious literacy and chaplain-like impartiality

The Coach should possess broad religious literacy comparable in spirit to a military chaplain serving people of many faiths: capable of respectful conversation without proselytizing, without pretending to be clergy, and without substituting his theology for the Candidate's. If the Candidate is Sikh, for example, the Coach should help him consider Masonic moral and spiritual lessons in a way that strengthens rather than weakens his own faith, and refer theological questions to competent authorities in that tradition when appropriate.

- In tyled, closed formal Craft Lodge business meetings, the working rule is no sectarian religious, partisan political, or deliberately controversial debate; verify the exact current jurisdictional wording when needed.
- Outside those meetings, open and respectful discussions are encouraged as conversations, not contests or proselytizing debates.
- The Coach asks: 'Are you learning and understanding this degree?'
- The Mentor asks: 'What kind of Mason are you becoming, and what path is right for you?'
- One Brother may fill both functions, but the functions remain distinct.

The catechism is the curriculum; the Candidate is the student. The goal is not merely a man who can answer the questions, but a Mason who understands why the questions remain worth asking.

5. Total Membership, Attraction, Retention, and the Family Model

The membership-development model is not a sales funnel in the ordinary commercial sense. Freemasonry is a voluntary fraternity whose public presence should make the Craft understandable, discoverable, and worthy of inquiry while preserving the man's free choice. The Lodge therefore develops culture, relationships, education, and stewardship rather than treating membership as a commodity.

Standing attraction rule: Target the message. Educate the demographic. Allow the man to become an Aspirant of his own free will.

The Total Membership cycle

Function	Lifecycle focus	Working purpose
Attraction	Profane / Inquirer -> Aspirant	Create a visible, positive, accurate public presence; answer questions; communicate values; never manufacture desire or solicit a petition.
Attention	Aspirant / Petitioner / Elect / Candidate	Respond promptly, explain expectations, perform due diligence, provide Coach and Mentor support, and guide the man through lawful onboarding.
Retention	Entered Apprentice -> Fellow Craft -> Master Mason -> Member in Good Standing	Meet fraternal, ritual, educational, social, charitable, community, mentorship, recognition, and leadership-development needs.
Restoration	Demit, NPD, inactive, or estranged Brother as permitted by law	Understand why the Brother left; distinguish discipline from hardship, neglect, conflict, health, finances, religion, family, misunderstanding, or disillusionment; restore only when lawful, desired, and appropriate.

The Three Gates

Gate	Question	Stewardship
West Gate	Who enters	Guard qualification, character, readiness, truthfulness, and mutual fit. This is Guarding the Gate, not arbitrary gatekeeping.
South Gate	Who leaves	Study avoidable attrition and restore relationships where appropriate. A Brother who disengages is not merely a lost dues payment; his departure is a formation and fellowship question.
East Gate	Who leads	Leadership is a meritorious responsibility, not an automatic entitlement. Prepare officers deliberately and match authority with competence, character, education, and service.

Family Model - not commodity model

- Membership cannot be sold, transferred, lent, gifted, or treated as a consumer purchase.

- A healthy Masonic family builds culture, teaches tradition, mentors new members, expects responsibility, celebrates achievement, corrects with justice, and prepares the next generation of leaders.
- Quality is preferred to raw quantity. Selectivity means lawful discernment of qualification and fit, not arbitrary exclusion.
- Ordinary business practices remain useful for finance, compliance, communications, planning, safety, records, and public relations, but the fraternity itself should not be reduced to a commercial product or customer transaction.
- The greatest public brand is lived conduct: every Mason functions as an Ambassador whose character helps shape the public's perception of the Craft.

Member needs that sustain belonging

Need	What the Lodge should cultivate
Fraternal	Brotherhood, trust, family-like bonds, mutual care, and shared purpose.
Ritual	Excellent conferral, accurate instruction, and understanding beyond rote memorization.
Educational	History, symbolism, philosophy, jurisprudence, practical application, and thoughtful programs.
Social	Fellowship that respects family life, time, and the need for genuine human connection.
Charitable	Meaningful support of lawful Masonic charitable efforts without reducing Freemasonry to charity alone.
Community	Constructive civic presence and service that makes Masonry a visible good neighbor.
Mentorship	A durable support network that guides the Brother throughout life and Masonry.
Recognition	Appropriate acknowledgment of effort, growth, service, and achievement.
Leadership Opportunity	Training, responsibility, succession planning, and safe opportunities to learn by doing.

Target demographic - precise Masonic use

A target demographic is a defined segment of the public identified by shared characteristics such as age, location, life stage, interests, education, vocation, family status, income, or communication habits. In Masonic use, the concept identifies whom public education and communication are designed to reach; it does not identify whom the Lodge is entitled to pressure or solicit for membership.

- Use demographic analysis to decide which questions public education should answer, which communication channels are useful, and which life-stage concerns deserve attention.
- Public messaging may be intentionally relevant to men likely to value fraternity, moral development, service, leadership, heritage, family, education, and community.
- A target demographic is not a list of men to ask to join. The Lodge targets communication; the individual supplies the desire.

Petitioner-age evidence

The age figures in the 2022 membership presentation measure the age of the Petitioner when he signed or submitted his Petition to a Symbolic Craft Lodge - not the present age of the Lodge's membership. That denominator must remain explicit.

Evidence	Reported result	How to use it
Utah archival sample	18-24: about 15%; 25-44: about 60%; 45-54: about 15%; 55+: about 10%; reported mean near age 33.	A jurisdictional sample drawn from historical Lodge petitions, rosters, minutes, and histories; useful as a local data set and comparison point.
Reported North American benchmark	Typical Petitioner reported in approximately the 33-37 range, with a reported median near age 35.	Attributed in the working record to Masonic Service Association of North America, Masonic Information Center, Rocky Mountain Conference, and Conference of Grand Masters sources. Obtain the exact underlying report before publishing the statistic as a formal national estimate.
Petitioner demographic is not membership demographic. A Lodge may have an older current membership while the men historically petitioning it most often entered in their thirties.		

Retention, continued Masonic engagement, and the Rites

The 2022 speaker notes report a larger North American Masonic membership and retention study undertaken across Craft and major appendant-body leadership. The working account identifies participation by the Scottish Rite Southern Jurisdiction, Scottish Rite Northern Masonic Jurisdiction, Shriners International, General Grand Chapter of Royal Arch Masons International, General Grand Council Cryptic Masons International, Grand Encampment of Knights Templar, U.S.A., and Grand Jurisdictions participating through the Conference of Grand Masters of North America.

- A reported result of that larger study was materially stronger retention among Brothers who continued into York Rite and/or Scottish Rite, expressed in the working materials as an approximately 30-45% reduction in departure.
- Treat 30-45% as a reported inter-Masonic study result until the exact underlying report, methodology, denominator, and confidence limits are obtained and cited directly.
- The broader research environment informed later coordinated membership work, including Scottish Rite Northern Masonic Jurisdiction's Path Forward program and the public-facing BeAFreemason.org campaign developed with partner Masonic organizations.

- The educational conclusion is stronger than the statistic alone: continuing Masonic engagement can deepen relationships, identity, education, responsibility, service, and reasons to remain active.
- York Rite and Scottish Rite should therefore be introduced as legitimate opportunities for continued Masonic growth - not merely as mechanisms for increasing appendant-body membership.

5-4-3-2-1 action challenge - interpreted through free choice

Challenge	Rite Architect interpretation
5 - Introduce	Make Freemasonry visible and understandable to appropriate members of the public; educate and inform rather than solicit.
4 - Support	Actively support Brothers, candidates, families, Lodges, and Masonic bodies through fellowship and service.
3 - Create	Help the Lodge form new Masons after men independently aspire, petition, are elected, and lawfully proceed through the Degrees.
2 - Restore	Seek lawful, respectful restoration of Brothers who have drifted away when the Brother desires return and the governing Code permits it.
1 - Mentor	Take durable responsibility for guiding at least one Brother in life and Masonry.

Long-range institutional stewardship

- Reject the 'my year' mentality and the search for a single silver-bullet membership solution.
- Use a shared 7-to-10-year vision across officer lines, with measurable goals, succession planning, and continuity of institutional purpose.
- Practice Constant Forward Motion with perpetual review: adapt, correct mistakes, preserve what works, and remain flexible without abandoning principle.
- Plans serve the mission; the mission is the formation, welfare, and continued growth of men and the Craft.

Membership development begins before the Petition and continues long after the Third Degree: inform well, discern carefully, initiate worthily, educate thoroughly, mentor continuously, retain meaningfully, and restore compassionately where lawful.

6. Religion, the Supreme Being, the Great Architect, and Light

Supreme Being

Working definition: the ultimate, highest, uncreated Divine Being - the Creator and sustaining source of existence, worthy of reverence and worship. The phrase is superlative: it should not be diluted to mean merely a force, institution, ancestor, lesser spiritual entity, social ideal, or anything a person considers 'bigger than himself.'

The working Masonic formulation used in these conversations is the Fatherhood of God, the Brotherhood of Man, and the immortality of the soul. The exact legal wording of religious qualifications must always be verified with the current governing jurisdiction.

Great Architect of the Universe (G.A.O.T.U.)

G.A.O.T.U. is a nonsectarian Masonic appellation for Deity expressed through the builder's art: God symbolically as Creator, Designer, Orderer, and Sustainer. It is not a separate Masonic god and not a substitute religion. Architect is the metaphor; the Supreme Being is the referent.

The Lodge supplies a common symbolic title. The Brother's faith supplies his theology.

Religious toleration and qualification

- Freemasonry is not a religion and does not claim salvation, sacraments, or a sectarian theology.
- Freemasonry should strengthen, not replace, a Brother's own faith and duty to God.
- Religious tolerance means qualified men are not rejected merely because of denomination or sect; it does not erase the religious qualifications imposed by the governing Grand Lodge.
- Sincere belief, not philosophical sophistication, is the relevant qualification. A man need not be able to defend Aquinas, Maimonides, Ibn Sina, Anselm, or any formal proof of God to possess faith.
- An avowed atheist cannot truthfully satisfy a jurisdictional requirement to believe in a Supreme Being.

Satanism / Luciferianism in this working model

Standing Utah-oriented working rule: Satanism and Luciferianism are treated as incompatible with the religious and harmony requirements of this framework. The clearest documented case is Church of Satan / LaVeyan Satanism, whose own FAQ

explicitly describes its position as atheistic, denies supernatural deity, and treats the individual as the 'god' of the subjective universe. That position cannot satisfy a requirement of sincere belief in a Supreme Being.

For public factual claims about other Satanist, Luciferian, Setian, parody-religion, or mock-religion labels, do not rely on a label alone or attribute sweeping beliefs without evidence. Use authoritative descriptions of the group's doctrine, the petitioner's own sincere professed beliefs, and the current jurisdiction's actual requirements. The internal working rule may be firm; external claims must still be documented accurately.

Masonic Light is not Luciferian

Masonic Light is a symbol of truth, knowledge, moral understanding, spiritual illumination, and apprehension of Divine order. The Latin word lucifer historically means 'light-bearer' or 'morning star' and only later became a traditional proper name for Satan in much Christian usage. That linguistic history does not make Masonic Light Luciferian. In Christian theology, Jesus as the 'Light of the World' is a specifically Christian interpretation; in a nonsectarian Lodge, the symbol is taught while the Brother's faith interprets its theology.

7. The nine Sacred Duties / daily priorities

This hierarchy is a central working rule. The order matters because Freemasonry exists to help a man fulfill the duties above it, not to compete with them.

1. **God** - Treat God, as understood within the Brother's faith and consistent with Masonic qualification, as the Chief Good and first object of devotion and duty.
2. **Country** - Be loyal to the country in which one resides; be a quiet, peaceful citizen obedient to just laws and faithful to lawful civic duties.
3. **Community** - Lift and improve the community through responsible participation, service, and constructive citizenship.
4. **Neighbors** - Be civil, kind, courteous, helpful, quick to forgive, and slow to judge.
5. **Friends** - Be dependable, encouraging, loyal, honest, and present in meaningful ways.
6. **Family** - Be a good spouse, husband, father, brother, son, and relative; love, support, empathize, and remain present in trials and triumphs.
7. **Vocation** - Be industrious, competent, honest, trustworthy, and ethical in work; inspire confidence through integrity.
8. **Self** - Practice self-discipline and continual improvement of mind, body, heart, and soul, including healthy sleep, food, exercise, and habits.
9. **Fraternity** - Use Masonic fellowship, moral instruction, accountability, and peer association to become better than the man one was the day before - not better than other men.

A healthy Masonic journey strengthens the first eight priorities. A Mentor should sometimes tell a Brother to choose worship, family, health, work, or civic duty over a Masonic event.

All humanity possesses equal human dignity. Masonic Brotherhood creates particular reciprocal duties among Brothers, but 'more especially a Brother Mason' never means that non-Masons have lesser human worth.

8. Language of Membership

Masonic language should describe the actual act, status, and authority involved. The broad word 'join' is useful in casual speech, but it should not erase the distinctions among inquiry, petition, election, initiation, advancement, affiliation, good standing, suspension, demit, expulsion, degree, Order, rank, decoration, and honor.

Core membership verbs and distinctions

Word	Precise working use
Inquire	Ask for information without yet expressing a desire to join.
Aspire	Express a self-generated desire or interest in becoming a Mason.
Petition	Formally ask a Lodge or body for admission; the petition remains the man's own act.
Receive a petition	The Lodge accepts the petition for lawful processing; this is not election.
Investigate	Perform impartial due diligence concerning character, qualification, sincerity, and understanding.
Ballot / Elect	The lawful body decides whether the Petitioner is elected; eligibility and petition do not create entitlement.
Initiate	Use specifically for entrance into the Entered Apprentice Degree unless the governing ritual uses the word otherwise.
Pass	Use for advancement to the Degree of Fellow Craft.

Word	Precise working use
Raise	Use for advancement to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason.
Advance / Receive / Exalt / Create / Constitute / Invest / Coronet / Bestow	Use the exact body-specific verb for the actual degree, Order, rank, decoration, or honor involved.
Affiliate	Become a member of another Lodge or body after lawful admission according to its governing law.
Demit / Demission	A formal severance or transfer of Lodge membership; exact effects and procedures are jurisdiction-specific.
Suspend / Expel	Disciplinary statuses imposed under governing Masonic law; exact authority, downstream effects, appeal rights, and reinstatement rules must be verified in the controlling Code.

Membership is not entitlement

- Eligibility is not entitlement.
- Petition is not election.
- Election is not initiation.
- Initiation is not proficiency.
- Proficiency is not mastery.
- Master Mason status is not the end of Masonic development.
- Fees support the process and dues support the Lodge; neither purchases worthiness, election, advancement, friendship, or honor.
- Membership is an institutional relationship; belonging is created relationally through education, fellowship, service, responsibility, and time.

Never sell Masonic membership as a product. Present it as a voluntary, qualified, elected, initiated, educated, responsible, and sustained relationship with the Craft.

9. York Rite and Scottish Rite orientation

Education about the broader Masonic family should begin as soon as the Candidate has been passed to the Fellow Craft Degree. The purpose is not pressure or premature petitioning; it is to give him enough accurate information to reach a logical conclusion, make an informed decision, and exercise an educated choice once he becomes eligible.

- Fellow Craft stage: explain what the York Rite and Scottish Rite are, how they relate to the Symbolic Lodge, their broad themes, structures, prerequisites, time/cost commitments, fellowship, education, and service opportunities.
- Master Mason stage: help the Brother compare paths and consider his own interests, faith, goals, family, time, and finances.
- Eligibility / good-standing stage: present actionable opportunities, then let the Brother decide freely.
- Do not imply that either Rite is required to be a complete Master Mason.
- Do not disparage a body because the Mentor is not a member of it. Where the Mentor lacks firsthand knowledge, say so and make an introduction to a knowledgeable Brother or official source.

Precise language of membership, progression, titles, and governance

When precision matters, do not flatten the Masonic journey into 'joined,' 'got a degree,' or 'became a member.' Use the body-specific verbs, resulting statuses, styles of address, and governing relationships supplied in the working overview. These terms identify what actually occurred and the body in which it occurred. Exact forms remain subject to current jurisdictional law and ritual regulation.

Precision rule: Petitioned is not elected; elected is not initiated; initiated is not passed; passed is not raised; a degree is not automatically an Order, rank, decoration, or honor.

American Rite / York Rite working progression

Body	Precise action language	Resulting progression	Style	Government
Symbolic Lodge	Initiated an Entered Apprentice; Passed to the Degree of Fellow Craft; Raised to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason.	Entered Apprentice -> Fellow Craft -> Master Mason	Master Masons: Brother	Grand Lodge -> Lodge
Capitular Chapter	Advanced to Mark Master; Inducted into the Oriental Chair (Past Master Virtual); Received and Acknowledged a Most Excellent Master; Exalted to the Most Sublime Degree of Royal Arch.	Mark Master -> Past Master Virtual -> Most Excellent Master -> Royal Arch Mason	Royal Arch Masons: Companion	Grand Chapter -> Chapter; General Grand Chapter R.A.M. International is treated in the source as a voluntary association.
Cryptic Council	Received a Royal Master; Greeted a Select Master; a qualified Select	Royal Master -> Select Master -> Super Excellent Master	Cryptic Masons: Companion	Grand Council -> Council; General Grand Council Cryptic Masons

Body	Precise action language	Resulting progression	Style	Government
	Master may be Introduced into the mysteries of Super Excellent Master.			International is treated in the source as a voluntary association.
Chivalric Commandery	Created and Constituted a Knight of the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross; Admitted a Knight of the Order of St. Paul / Mediterranean Pass; Admitted a Knight of the Ancient Order of St. John of Jerusalem / Order of Malta; Created and Constituted a Knight of the Order of the Temple.	Red Cross -> Mediterranean Pass / St. Paul -> Malta -> Order of the Temple / Knight Templar	Knights Templar: Sir Knight	Grand Encampment, U.S.A. -> Grand Commandery -> Commandery

Commandery qualification note: The supplied overview treats Commandery as both independent and part of the York Rite system, requires good standing in the prerequisite bodies, and describes a Christian declaration of faith. Verify current Grand Encampment and local Grand Commandery statutes before publishing exact eligibility language. The source also distinguishes the Mediterranean Pass as a passing degree rather than an Order.

Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite - Southern Jurisdiction working progression

Body / status	Range	Precise action language	Style	Key distinction
Lodge of Perfection	4°-14°	A Master Mason in Good Standing is Advanced to Perfect Master (4°), then Received and Elected a Perfect Elu (14°).	Brother	Venerable Master
Chapter of Rose Croix	15°-18°	A 14° Perfect Elu is Received and Constituted a Knight of the Eagle and Pelican / Knight Rose+Croix of the Order of Heredom (18°).	Use source-specific style context	Wise Master
Council of Kadosh	19°-30°	An 18° Knight Rose+Croix is Created, Received and Constituted a Knight Kadosh of the White and Black Eagle (30°).	Sir Knight in the supplied overview	Commander
Consistory	31°-32°	A 30° Knight Kadosh is Constituted a Disciple and Soldier of the Holy Doctrine, Anointed and Elevated a Master of the Royal Secret (32°).	32° Master of the Royal Secret: Brother	Master of Kadosh
Court of Honour	KCCH	A 32° Master of the Royal Secret may be Invested with the Rank, Honour, and Decoration of Knight Commander of the Court of Honour.	Honorable	Not a degree; invitational rank/decoration.
Supreme Council Honour	33° IGH	A qualified KCCH may be Coroneted an Inspector General Honorary of the Thirty-third Degree.	Illustrious	Honorary 33° conferred by the Supreme Council.
Grand Cross	33° GC	A 33° Inspector General Honorary may have the Grand Cross of the Court of Honour Bestowed and Received.	Illustrious	An honor, not another degree.

Use the correct body and presiding title

System	Constituent / operating body	Presiding title	Governing relationship
Symbolic Lodge	Lodge	Worshipful Master	Grand Lodge
Capitular Masonry	Chapter	Excellent High Priest	Grand Chapter
Cryptic Masonry	Council	Illustrious Master	Grand Council
Chivalric Masonry	Commandery	Eminent Commander	Grand Commandery / Grand Encampment
Scottish Rite 4°-14°	Lodge of Perfection	Venerable Master	Valley / Orient / Supreme Council
Scottish Rite 15°-18°	Chapter of Rose Croix	Wise Master	Valley / Orient / Supreme Council
Scottish Rite 19°-30°	Council of Kadosh	Commander	Valley / Orient / Supreme Council
Scottish Rite 31°-32°	Consistory	Master of Kadosh	Valley / Orient / Supreme Council
Scottish Rite Orient	Orient	Sovereign Grand Inspector General or Deputy	Supreme Council
Scottish Rite Valley	Valley	Deputy Inspector General or Personal Representative to the SGIG	Orient

Scottish Rite organizational language in the supplied Southern Jurisdiction overview follows: Supreme Council -> Orient -> Valley -> Lodge of Perfection, Chapter of Rose Croix, Council of Kadosh, and Consistory, together with authorized clubs and committees. Utah is identified as an Orient, and the Valley of Salt Lake is used as a local example.

Language discipline for future conversations

- Use 'Brother' for a Master Mason and ordinary Scottish Rite address as appropriate; 'Companion' for Royal Arch and Cryptic Masonry; 'Sir Knight' for Commandery; 'Honorable' for KCCH; and 'Illustrious' for the 33° honors described in the source.
- Distinguish the legal relationship of membership from the ceremonial act by which a degree, Order, rank, decoration, or honor is conferred.
- Do not call KCCH a 'degree.' It is an invitational rank, honor, and decoration. Do not call the Grand Cross another degree; it is an honor.

- Do not use 'joined the York Rite' when the precise fact is that a Brother petitioned a Chapter, was elected, and was Advanced, Inducted, Received and Acknowledged, or Exalted according to the particular stage.
- Do not use 'got his Scottish Rite degrees' where precise verbs are available. Use Advanced, Received and Elected, Received and Constituted, Created/Received/Constituted, Anointed and Elevated, Invested, Coroneted, or Bestowed as applicable.
- Use current governing-body terminology when it differs from this working overview; document the variation rather than silently blending systems.

The three-envelope presentation - Utah working practice

About one week after the Brother reaches the model's Member-in-Good-Standing milestone, the Mentor should celebrate the Brother's success and present at least three separately marked envelopes, with petitions prepared as far as legitimately possible so the Brother can review, affirm, sign, and pay the appropriate fees if he chooses:

- 1) Keystone Mark Master Masons Lodge No. 00.
- 2) His local York Rite Bodies: Chapter, Council, and Commandery, subject to all applicable qualifications.
- 3) His local Scottish Rite Valley within the appropriate Orient: Lodge of Perfection, Chapter of Rose Croix, Council of Kadosh, and Consistory.

The presentation should feel celebratory, not transactional. Administrative fields may be prepared in advance, but personal declarations, belief statements, attestations, and choices must remain the Brother's own and should be reviewed and affirmed by him.

The Mentor may have preferences; the mentorship process may not. Inform completely. Represent fairly. Disclose limits. Make introductions. Preserve free choice. Support the Brother's decision.

10. Historical Development of the American Rite / York Rite and Scottish Rite

The Rite Architect presents the American Rite / York Rite and the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite as products of historical development within the wider family of Freemasonry. Their modern boundaries were not all fixed at the beginning of speculative Masonry. Degrees, Orders, lectures, and governing systems circulated, developed, were reorganized, and were eventually placed under distinct competent authorities. This development should be presented positively, but never as a reason to blur documented history, jurisdiction, or present procedural law.

Historical-development rule: Freemasonry is progressive in instruction and historically developmental in organization. Modern Rites are best understood as disciplined syntheses of earlier Masonic traditions - not as inventions without antecedents, and not as proof that every modern body existed in its present form from antiquity.

Pure Antient Masonry and the 1813 English settlement

- Article II of the 1813 Articles of Union declared that 'pure Antient Masonry' consists of three degrees - Entered Apprentice, Fellow Craft, and Master Mason - including the Supreme Order of the Holy Royal Arch.
- The original Article II also stated that this definition was not intended to prevent a Lodge or Chapter from meeting in degrees of the Orders of Chivalry according to the constitutions of those Orders. That second sentence was later omitted from the Preliminary Declaration printed in the UGLE Book of Constitutions.
- The Antients treated the Royal Arch as the culmination of their Craft system. UGLE today calls Royal Arch the fourth and final stage in Pure Antient Masonry while retaining the constitutional language of three degrees.
- This English constitutional settlement is important historical evidence, but it is not a universal definition of every regular jurisdiction's complete Masonic system.

From a shared eighteenth-century Masonic environment to the American Rite

The American Rite / York Rite did not appear all at once as a single national organization. Its constituent traditions developed in Britain, Ireland, Scotland, continental Europe, the British-American colonies, and the early United States. Royal Arch, Mark, Past Master, Excellent / Most Excellent, Cryptic, and Templar material was worked under changing arrangements before the modern American pattern of Lodge -> Chapter -> Council -> Commandery became broadly established.

Developmental stream	Modern American expression	Historical reading
Craft foundation	EA -> FC -> MM	The three Craft Degrees remain the indispensable foundation. A Mason must not be taught that York Rite or Scottish Rite is required to make the Third Degree 'valid' or the Master Mason somehow incomplete as a Mason.
Royal Arch / Capitular development	Mark Master -> Past Master (Virtual) -> Most Excellent Master -> Royal Arch	In American Royal Arch Masonry these degrees became organized as a progressive Chapter system. The Past Master tradition reflects the historical association between the Master's Chair and admission to the Royal Arch.

Developmental stream	Modern American expression	Historical reading
Cryptic development	Royal Master -> Select Master; Super Excellent Master as governed locally	Royal and Select Master traditions developed separately and were later brought together under Council systems in the early nineteenth century. Jeremy Ladd Cross is closely associated with the organization of the early American Cryptic system; the first Grand Council in Connecticut dates to 1819.
Chivalric development	Red Cross -> Mediterranean Pass / St. Paul -> Malta -> Temple, according to the governing ritual	American Templary existed before a unified national system. The first recorded North American conferral of the Order of the Temple cited by Grand Encampment is William Davis on 28 Aug. 1769; Paul Revere followed on 11 Dec. 1769. Grand Encampment organization came in 1816.
Integrated American pattern	Lodge -> Chapter -> Council -> Commandery	The modern American Rite is an institutional synthesis of related but historically distinct streams. Prerequisites and the necessity of Council before Commandery have varied by jurisdiction and period.

Paul Revere and the language of early American Templary

Paul Revere may be described, on the Grand Encampment's published record, as the second person of record in North America to receive the Order of the Temple. He should not be described as the second member of a fully formed 'American York Rite System,' because the later integrated Chapter-Council-Commandery structure and its national governing organizations did not yet exist in 1769. His reception is better understood as evidence that the Masonic Templar stream was already active in the British-American world from which the later American Rite developed.

Cryptic Masonry: preserve the tradition, correct the chronology

Traditions sometimes connect the Royal and Select Master degrees closely with the broader high-degree environment that also produced the Scottish Rite. That relationship is historically plausible at the level of shared eighteenth- and early-nineteenth-century degree culture, but the claim that Albert Pike created the Cryptic Degrees from material that would not fit his Scottish Rite revision should not be presented as established fact.

- Royal and Select Master workings and Council organization predate Pike's major Scottish Rite revisions.
- The General Grand Council's own historical materials identify Jeremy Ladd Cross with the early consolidation of the American Cryptic system and the first Grand Council of Royal and Select Masters in Connecticut in 1819.
- Pike's era is important to later questions of high-degree jurisdiction and classification. Where a Pike-based tradition is discussed, label it as tradition or jurisprudential interpretation unless a primary Pike text establishes the exact claim.

Scottish Rite development: European high degrees to an American system

Historical stage	Development	How to present it
Eighteenth-century high-degree environment	Numerous additional Masonic degrees and systems circulated in Europe and the Atlantic world.	Historical context - do not project the later 33-degree Southern Jurisdiction backward onto every eighteenth-century working.
Rite of Perfection / Morin tradition	A major stream of high-degree Masonry helped transmit and organize material that fed the later Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite.	Documented development mixed with traditional constitutional narratives; distinguish archival proof from later origin legends.
Charleston, 1801	The first Supreme Council of the 33-degree system was established at Charleston, South Carolina, becoming the Mother Supreme Council of the world in Scottish Rite tradition and institutional history.	Foundational Southern Jurisdiction milestone.
Albert Pike, mid-nineteenth century	Pike transcribed, studied, reorganized, expanded, and rewrote substantial portions of the Southern Jurisdiction rituals; he served as Sovereign Grand Commander from 1859 to 1891.	Pike was a major systematizer and interpreter, not the creator of Freemasonry or the original inventor of all Scottish Rite degrees.
Modern Southern Jurisdiction	Lodge of Perfection -> Chapter of Rose Croix -> Council of Kadosh -> Consistory, with honors such as KCCH and 33° IGH governed separately.	Use the precise verbs, body names, honors, and governing structure already defined in this Framework.

Parallel development, not rivalry

- The American Rite / York Rite and Scottish Rite should be presented as parallel avenues of continued Masonic education that grew from overlapping historical environments but matured under different governing systems.
- Shared themes - Temple traditions, Biblical narratives, chivalric imagery, moral philosophy, historical drama, and progressive instruction - do not make the two Rites institutionally interchangeable.
- Neither Rite should be advertised as the only authentic continuation of Craft Masonry, and neither should be disparaged to promote the other.
- The most accurate recruitment message is developmental: the Master Mason has completed the Craft foundation and may now explore additional lawful Masonic systems whose modern structures preserve and interpret different streams of the fraternity's historical inheritance.

Mentorship formulation: The Craft establishes the foundation. The American Rite develops a progressive Capitular, Cryptic, and Chivalric journey. The Scottish Rite develops a broad philosophical, moral, historical, and dramatic curriculum. Both are legitimate

continuations of Masonic education under their own competent authorities.

Historical fact, tradition, and interpretation - keep the labels visible

Category	Examples	Rule
Documented fact	Article II of the 1813 Union; UGLE's present Royal Arch description; 1769 Davis/Revere Templar record; 1816 Grand Encampment organization; Pike's ritual revisions and Grand Commandership.	State directly and cite the responsible authority.
Historical tradition	Legendary constitutional claims, medieval continuities, claims that a particular high degree came directly from a medieval Order, or that Pike personally originated Cryptic Masonry.	Preserve when educationally valuable, but label as tradition unless primary evidence establishes it.
Scholarly interpretation	How scattered high degrees influenced one another; why a degree moved between jurisdictions; how English and American systems diverged.	Present as interpretation supported by evidence, not as a Landmark or universal law.
Present procedural law	Who may petition, prerequisites, degree sequence, recognition, fees, jurisdiction, and governing-body authority.	Verify with the current Code, Constitution, ritual regulation, or governing body. Historical practice does not override present law.

11. Regularity, Recognition, Masonic Authority, and Organizational Status

Regularity and recognition are separate but allied concepts. Regularity concerns whether a Grand Lodge meets the applicable standards by which another jurisdiction evaluates Masonic legitimacy. Recognition is the sovereign act by which a Grand Lodge acknowledges another Grand Lodge for fraternal relations. A body may not simply recognize itself into amity.

Commission on Information for Recognition - current North American standard

- The Commission was organized in 1951; its Standards for Recognition were adopted in 1952.
- The current three-part standard is: (1) legitimacy of origin; (2) exclusive territorial jurisdiction, except by mutual consent and/or treaty; and (3) adherence to the Ancient Landmarks, specifically belief in God, the Volume of Sacred Law as indispensable Lodge furniture, and prohibition of political and religious discussion in Lodge.
- The Commission investigates and reports. It expressly does not advise or recommend that recognition be granted.
- The final decision to recognize, continue recognition, suspend relations, or withdraw recognition belongs to the sovereign Grand Lodge concerned.
- Recognition status is dynamic. When visitation, affiliation, inter-jurisdictional communication, or credentials depend on recognition, verify the current status rather than relying on an old report.

Do not silently merge different recognition systems

- The North American Commission's three Standards are its own working standard.
- The United Grand Lodge of England's 1929 Basic Principles are a separate eight-point recognition framework and should be attributed to UGLE.
- Mackey, Pound, and other Landmark systems are jurisprudential formulations, not universal Masonic legislation.
- The controlling question for an individual Mason is always what his own sovereign Grand Lodge recognizes, prohibits, permits, and requires.

Phylaxis Society Commission on Bogus Masonry

- The Phylaxis Commission emphasizes documented lineage and lawful Masonic authority, especially in the Prince Hall context through African Lodge No. 459 and recognized English, Irish, or Scottish lines of authority.
- A civil corporation, nonprofit registration, tax status, website, seal, title, patent, familiar ritual, regalia, or self-declared Grand Lodge does not by itself create Masonic authority.
- Similarity of form is not continuity of authority.
- When the Phylaxis Commission classifies a body as bogus, attribute that classification to the Commission rather than presenting the adjective as an unattributed universal judgment.
- A man who was misled into an organization that lacks legitimate Masonic authority is not automatically a bad man. Separate the status of the organization from the man's own knowledge, intent, character, truthfulness, and present qualifications.

**Corporate existence answers: 'Does this legal entity exist?' Regularity asks: 'By what Masonic authority does this body exist?'
Recognition asks: 'Which sovereign Masonic jurisdictions are in fraternal relations with it?'**

Preferred neutral language

When a more specific competent-authority classification is unnecessary, disputed, or unavailable, use the following standing language:

Person: 'a member of an organization that does not meet the basic requirements of the Standards of Regularity/Recognition.'
Organization: 'an organization that does not meet the basic requirements of the Standards of Regularity/Recognition.'

- When possible, identify the actual defect more precisely: origin, practice, territorial standing, or lack of recognition by a named sovereign Grand Lodge.
- Do not use 'clandestine,' 'irregular,' 'unrecognized,' and 'bogus' as automatic synonyms. Their usage varies and should be attributed to the authority applying the term.
- Describe the condition first; attribute the classification second.

Five-question verification model

- Identity - What exactly is the organization claiming to be?
- Authority - From what competent Masonic authority does it claim its Charter, Warrant, or lawful descent?
- Regularity - Does its origin and practice satisfy the standards applied by the relevant jurisdiction?
- Recognition - Does the Mason's own sovereign Grand Lodge currently recognize it and permit Masonic intercourse?
- Personal qualification - If an individual comes from such a body, is he personally worthy, well qualified, properly informed, truthful, and eligible under the controlling Masonic law?

Status changes: suspension, expulsion, and demit

Older Masonic jurisprudence often treats Craft Lodge suspension or expulsion as having downstream consequences for appendant-body membership because appendant bodies require continuing Craft qualification, while an appendant-body penalty does not necessarily erase Craft membership. Likewise, demit, transfer, sojourning status, rights of visitation, appeal, and reinstatement vary materially by jurisdiction. Treat these as Code questions, not universal assumptions.

Fraternity and charitable entities

Freemasonry should be described principally as a fraternity or fraternal order, not merely as 'a charity.' Many Masonic bodies and their charitable foundations are separate legal entities with different tax classifications. Never assume a particular 501(c) status from a body's name; verify the actual entity and current filing when legal or financial accuracy matters.

12. Obedience and Constituted Authority

Classical Masonic jurisprudence strongly emphasizes obedience to constituted authority as a safeguard of order. The working hierarchy is Mason -> Lodge -> Grand Lodge -> the governing Constitution, Regulations, established usages, and whatever the jurisdiction recognizes as fundamental Masonic law.

What obedience means

- Masonic obedience attaches to lawful office and lawful jurisdiction, not to personality, seniority, popularity, title, or decoration.
- A Worshipful Master, Grand Master, Lodge, or Grand Lodge exercises only the authority actually granted by the governing law.
- Older language directing a Mason to 'put his elder to worship' uses 'worship' in the historical sense of honor, dignity, or respect - not religious adoration.
- A Mason may obey a lawful ruling with which he disagrees without surrendering his judgment. Obedience governs conduct; it does not require intellectual servility.

Obedience and appeal are paired principles

- Obedience preserves order.
- Appeal restrains error and abuse.
- The ordinary remedy for an erroneous, improper, or unjust exercise of Masonic authority is the lawful review, grievance, jurisprudence, trial, Grand Master, or Grand Lodge process provided by the controlling Code.
- The exact route of appeal is jurisdiction-specific. Read the Code.

Authority descends through lawful constitution; accountability ascends through lawful appeal.

Boundary of obedience

The older jurisprudential language of 'passive obedience' should not be converted into a universal modern rule that a Mason must knowingly commit an unlawful, fraudulent, dangerous, or professionally unethical act because a Masonic superior ordered it. No Masonic authority can legitimately convert wrongdoing into duty.

- A Masonic order does not authorize lying, perjury, evidence destruction, obstruction of justice, theft, falsification of records, unlawful discrimination, or breach of professional ethics.

- The nine Sacred Duties control the hierarchy: duty to God and Truth, just civil law, and honest vocation stand above Fraternity.
- A Mason obeys because the authority is lawfully constituted - not because the authority is infallible.

13. Truth, justice, law, vocation, and Brotherly obligation

Truth is treated in this framework as a Divine attribute. To be good and true is foundational; integrity, honor, and fidelity depend on honesty and moral conduct. Brotherly Love therefore cannot require a Brother to become dishonest.

Crime and the common conspiracy hypothetical

If an accused Mason encountered a police officer, sheriff, detective, booking officer, prosecutor, defense attorney, bailiff, witness, stenographer, or judge who were also Masons, Masonic Brotherhood would not authorize any of them to lie, commit perjury, suppress or fabricate evidence, obstruct justice, falsify records, violate lawful process, or breach professional ethics.

- Police and investigators: investigate and report truthfully; preserve evidence; follow lawful procedure.
- Prosecutor: seek justice honestly; disclose and handle evidence according to law and professional duty.
- Defense counsel: provide loyal and competent lawful representation and preserve legitimate attorney-client confidentiality, but never lie, fabricate evidence, or assist false testimony.
- Witness: tell the truth subject only to lawful privileges and protections; Masonic fraternity is not itself an evidentiary privilege.
- Court officers and stenographers: maintain accurate process and records.
- Judge: remain impartial and follow recusal/conflict rules where applicable.

Priority test: God and Truth first; Country and just law next; Vocation must be performed honestly; Fraternity is ninth. Brotherhood operates inside those higher duties, never against them.

A Brother accused or convicted of wrongdoing may still receive lawful compassion: humane treatment, help obtaining counsel, appropriate visitation, support for innocent family members, encouragement toward repentance and restitution, and prayer according to faith. Keeping a lawful confidence is not the same as concealing a crime.

14. Historical milestones to remember

Use these dates with precise historical wording. Where a feast-day association is calendrically true but documentary intent has not been established, describe it as an association rather than proof that the date was deliberately selected for that feast.

Date	Milestone	Standing wording / caution
24 June 1717	Premier Grand Lodge in London	UGLE's official history says four London Lodges met on St. John's Day and declared themselves a Grand Lodge. 'Moderns' was a later rival label.
24 June 1725	Grand Lodge of Ireland	First recorded Communication of Grand Lodge. Avoid the anachronistic phrase 'Republic of Ireland Grand Lodge.'
30 November 1736	Grand Lodge of Scotland	Inaugural formation in Edinburgh; the date is St. Andrew's Day. Use the body's formal 'Antient Free and Accepted Masons of Scotland' spelling when precision matters.
17 July 1751	English Antients	Rival English Grand Lodge established. Its long historical styles and Prince Edwin/York language belong to its own constitutional tradition; do not treat the 926 claim as independently proven history.
27 December 1813	United Grand Lodge of England	Union of the Premier/Modern and Antient Grand Lodges on St. John the Evangelist's Day.
16-20 January 1872	Grand Lodge of Utah	The Utah convention met to organize the Grand Lodge of Ancient Free and Accepted Masons of Utah. Current Utah historical material identifies organization in January 1872; surviving accounts place the organizing convention from 16 through 20 January.
20 January 1872	Utah closing milestone	The convention/proceedings culminated at the close of the organizing sessions. The association with St. Sebastian's feast is symbolically notable, but deliberate selection for that feast requires documentary proof.
1896-1897	Utah A.F.&A.M. -> F.&A.M. nomenclature question	Primary Utah material proves early use of 'Ancient Free and Accepted Masons of Utah' and later use of 'Free and Accepted Masons of Utah.' The claim that a clerical/misfiling error caused the permanent change remains an archival hypothesis until established by the original proceedings.

15. Standing structure for future conversations

Recruitment and public education

- Profane and Inquirer: educate and inform; never manufacture desire or ask them to join.
- Aspirant: once desire is self-expressed, begin mutual discernment and appropriate preliminary inquiry.
- Petitioner: formal request triggers lawful investigation, recommendation, and ballot; no guarantee of acceptance.
- Appender/Rites education: begin at Fellow Craft; actionable petitions come only after eligibility and preparation.

Educational standard

- Always distinguish documented history, etymology, current jurisdictional law, common tradition, interpretation, and speculation.
- Use primary or governing-body sources when exact eligibility, timing, law, or current practice matters.
- Do not overstate uncertain etymologies, especially Mason.
- Do not treat memorization as education. Aim for symbolic, historical, pragmatic, philosophical, moral, and spiritual understanding.
- A proficiency demonstrates sufficient progress for the next stage; it is not a declaration of complete mastery.

Mentorship standard

- Know the Candidate well enough to match him intelligently with a compatible Coach/Mentor.
- Support his faith without sectarian coercion.
- Expose him to the wider Masonic landscape early enough to make later decisions informed.
- Represent York Rite, Scottish Rite, and other appropriate opportunities without bias - especially when the Mentor does not belong to them.
- Never make the Brother's Masonic decisions for him.
- The long-term goal is to turn the instructed into an instructor, the guided into a guide, and the mentored into a mentor.

The process does not end when a man becomes a Master Mason. That is where the mentored Masonic journey properly begins.

16. One-page quick reference

Phase	Status	Rule
Public	Profane -> Inquirer	Inform. Answer. Do not solicit.
Interest	Aspirant	Mutual discernment; 6-18 months in the working model.
Formal request	Petitioner	Investigate impartially; about 2-4 months; read, report, ballot.
Selection	Elect	Prepare lawfully and deliberately.
Formation	Candidate -> EA -> proficiency -> FC -> proficiency -> MM -> proficiency	Coach teaches; Mentor guides; minimum intervals and readiness apply.
Broader orientation	Begins at Fellow Craft	Explain York Rite and Scottish Rite fairly and early.
Good standing	MM + required proficiency + support + dues, per working definition	About one week later, Mentor presents the three Utah opportunity envelopes.
Lifetime	Mentored Masonic Journey	Learn, serve, lead, choose freely, and eventually mentor others.
Precise body language	Lodge / Chapter / Council / Commandery / Scottish Rite bodies	Use exact ceremonial verbs, resulting status, style of address, and governing-body terminology; do not flatten all progression into 'joined' or 'got a degree.'
Membership language	Petition / election / initiation / advancement / affiliation / status	Use the exact act and status. Eligibility is not entitlement; fees and dues do not purchase advancement.
Regularity / Recognition	Grand Lodge and organizational legitimacy	Verify identity, authority, regularity, territorial standing, and current recognition. Attribute formal classifications.

Phase	Status	Rule
Obedience	Constituted Masonic authority	Obey lawful authority; appeal through the Code; never commit wrongdoing on Masonic command.
Historical claims	Grand Lodge milestones	Use official/primary history where possible and label feast-day symbolism or archival hypotheses as such.
Historical development	American Rite / York Rite and Scottish Rite	Present them as parallel, lawfully governed syntheses of earlier Masonic traditions. Promote continuity and progression without turning tradition into fact or present structure into ancient history.
Total Membership	Attraction -> Attention -> Retention -> Restoration	Treat membership as lifelong stewardship, not acquisition. Public education may be targeted; the man's aspiration remains voluntary.
Three Gates	West / South / East	Guard admission, understand attrition, and prepare leadership.
Target demographic	Public communication audience	Target the message, not the man's decision. Petitioner-age data measures age at petition, not current member age.
Retention research	Continued York / Scottish Rite engagement	Use the reported 30-45% result cautiously until the underlying study is directly cited; emphasize meaningful continued engagement rather than raw recruitment.

Core formulas

- Freemasonry informs; the individual chooses.
- Guard legitimate thresholds; do not create arbitrary barriers.
- Teach for understanding, not mere recitation.
- Educate early. Qualify properly. Decide freely. Proceed deliberately.
- The Lodge teaches the symbol; the Brother's faith interprets the theology.
- The Mentor may have preferences; the mentorship process may not.
- Brotherly Love requires lawful support, never dishonesty.
- Masonic improvement is comparative inwardly, not competitive outwardly.
- Precision in language protects precision in meaning: petition, election, degree, Order, rank, decoration, honor, style, and governing body are not interchangeable.
- Regularity is not recognition; recognition is not self-declared.
- Similarity of form is not continuity of authority.
- Describe the condition first; attribute the classification second.
- Corporate existence does not create Masonic authority.
- Authority descends through lawful constitution; accountability ascends through lawful appeal.
- A Mason obeys because authority is constituted, not because authority is infallible.
- Historical development is not historical license: celebrate the organic growth of the Rites while distinguishing documented fact, inherited tradition, scholarly interpretation, and current governing law.
- Target the message; do not manufacture the desire.
- Petitioner demographic is not membership demographic.
- Attraction earns inquiry; Attention forms the Candidate; Retention sustains belonging; Restoration repairs avoidable loss.
- The West Gate guards admission; the South Gate studies loss; the East Gate guards leadership.
- The purpose of continued Masonic opportunity is formation and belonging, not merely appendant-body headcount.

Source base and authority notes

This charter synthesizes the conversation, user-supplied materials, current verification sources, and the BeehiveMason research repositories listed below. It now also incorporates the 2022 Masonic Family membership program as a standing source for Total Membership, the Three Gates, the Family Model, public communication, petitioner demographics, retention, restoration, mentorship, and long-range institutional stewardship. Historical fact, historical tradition, scholarly interpretation, reported study results, local observational data, and current procedural law must remain visibly distinguished. This is a working educational framework, not an official publication of any Masonic governing body. Current recognition, amity, governing law, appendant-body eligibility, discipline, and legal/entity status must be verified with the present competent authority before publication or action.

ID	Source	Used for
S1	Ideal Onboarding Process (46 pages)	Aspirant/Petitioner/Candidate periods; investigation workflow; mentoring; degree/proficiency pathway; JotForm intake.
S2	The Personal Interview (9 pages)	Membership expectations, free-will emphasis,

ID	Source	Used for
		petitioner education, investigation suggestions, duties to God/country/community/family, fees/timing examples.
S3	G.A.O.T.U. / Great Architect of the Universe (3 pages)	Architect/Artificer as allegorical titles for Deity; Freemasonry and religion; Volume of Sacred Law.
S4	Supreme Being - encyclopedia excerpt	Creator, worship, classical theism, philosophical arguments and objections, plural religious usage.
S5	Church of Satan Frequently Asked Questions (45 pages)	Primary-source organizational statements that Church of Satan / LaVeyan Satanism is atheistic and rejects supernatural deity.
S6	Light not Lucifer (38 pages)	Christian 'Light of the World' material; Hebrew hehel / Latin Lucifer discussion; distinction between light symbolism and later Lucifer-as-Satan usage.
S7	User-supplied public-post material and discussion	Working claims and formulations concerning belief, Fatherhood of God/Brotherhood of Man, Masonic Light, anti-Masonic conspiracy responses, and religious qualification.
S8	Overview of the main journey of Freemasonry (10 pages)	Precise verbs of progression; member styles; Lodge/Chapter/Council/Commandery structure; Scottish Rite bodies, honors, presiding titles, and Supreme Council -> Orient -> Valley governance.
S9	Regularity Versus Recognition (12 pages)	Early working compilation on regularity, recognition, clandestine/irregular vocabulary, expulsion/demit, and fraternity-versus-charity questions. Use with jurisdictional and source-quality cautions.
S10	Regularity and Recognition: The Twin Pillars of Masonic Legitimacy (18 pages)	Research paper refining the distinction between regularity and recognition; Part II supersedes Part I and flags unresolved or source-dependent claims.
S11	Commission on Information for Recognition - current site and Resources	Current North American Standards for Recognition; Commission role; UGLE 1929 Basic Principles; historical reports. Verified 16 Aug. 2026.
S12	Phylaxis Society - Commission on Bogus Masonry	Lineage-based authority analysis, bogus-body classifications, educational treatment of men misled by such bodies, and court/history resources. Verified 16 Aug. 2026.
S13	Official Grand Lodge historical sources	UGLE, Grand Lodge of Ireland, Grand Lodge of Scotland, and Grand Lodge of Utah materials used to refine the historical chronology and terminology.
S14	BeehiveMason GitHub repositories: MembershipCommittee and ExotericFreemasonry	Working research library containing Antient Grand Lodge, Ahiman Rezon, Royal Arch development, early Royal Arch/Cryptic, Templary, Mackey, Cross, and related educational sources. Repository materials are source leads, not automatic proof.
S15	United Grand Lodge of England: Articles of Union / Royal Arch historical and current materials	1813 definition of Pure Antient Masonry; Antients/Moderns compromise; original Orders of Chivalry sentence; modern Royal Arch as fourth and final stage.
S16	General Grand Chapter, Royal Arch Masons International	Modern American Capitular degree structure and terminology: Mark Master, Past Master, Most Excellent Master, Royal Arch.
S17	General Grand Council of Cryptic Masons International	Cryptic Masonry as continued Masonic education; Royal/Select/Super Excellent structure; Jeremy Ladd Cross and early Grand Council historical references.
S18	Grand Encampment of Knights Templar, U.S.A. - Heritage	1769 William Davis and Paul Revere record; early American Encampments; 1816 national organization; later Commandery structure.
S19	Supreme Council, 33°, Southern Jurisdiction - history, archives, and Albert Pike materials	Scottish Rite development; Charleston 1801; Pike's transcriptions, revisions, scholarship, and 1859-1891 Grand Commandership.
S20	Masonic Family Speaker Notes, 28 October 2022 (71 pages)	Total Membership cycle; Three Gates; Family Model; member needs; mentorship; target-demographic strategy; Utah petitioner-age sample; 5-4-3-2-1 challenge; retention-study discussion; long-range planning.
S21	Attracting new membership: A challenge for the Masonic Family (48-slide presentation)	Visual companion to S20: Masonic Family map; '3 Degrees, 2 Rites, 1 Brotherhood'; Total Membership; Three Gates; Family Model; public communication and membership-development concepts.
S22	Reported North American membership / retention research discussed in S20 and subsequent working notes	Reported petitioner-age benchmark (33-37, median about 35) and reported 30-45% reduction in departure associated with York and/or Scottish Rite participation. Exact underlying primary study should be recovered before formal publication.
S23	Scottish Rite NMJ Path Forward / BeAFreemason.org institutional history	Broader membership-research environment and later public-facing Craft awareness campaign. Distinguish the research coalition from the specific organizations formally responsible for a given campaign phase.

Authority hierarchy for future answers

- 1) Current governing Masonic law and official body requirements when a jurisdiction-specific rule is at issue.
- 2) Primary historical documents for historical claims.
- 3) Official organizational sources for what an outside group says it believes.
- 4) Reliable scholarship for interpretation, classification, and contested history.
- 5) Common Masonic tradition and the user's working framework, clearly labeled as such.
- 6) Symbolic or philosophical interpretation, expressly identified as interpretation rather than fact.